

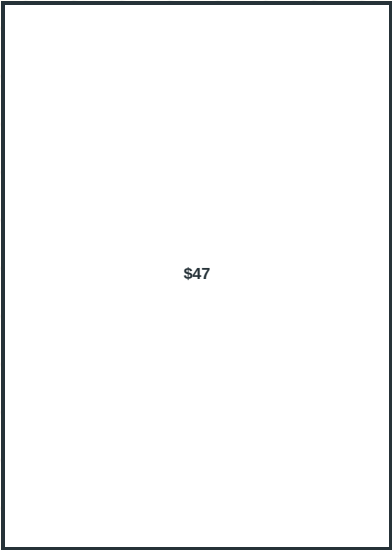
Coat Pocket Story Character Card Pack

Sixteen paper cards help writers create fictional story characters from made-up paper pocket items, wants, worries, actions, and voices.

Audience: Families, homeschool groups, tutors, and adult-led writing tables for writers ages 7-11.

Format: 16 printable character cards plus adult guide tools, character routines, take-home character slips, and optional share prompts

Family-safe printable writing pages for adult-led, offline story practice.



Included

- 16 printable coat-pocket character cards
- Adult setup guide
- Fictional character safety notes
- Pretend paper pocket coaching moves
- Privacy and family handoff notes
- Pack reset notes
- Six adult-led character routines
- Ten take-home character slips
- Eight optional share prompts
- Provider-ready PDF and ZIP artifact

Character coaching

Before the session

- Print the character cards, pocket label, and slips before the session; keep every piece paper-only and adult-led.
- Use a folded envelope or printed pouch labeled Pretend Paper Coat Pocket; never use or inspect real clothing.
- Set out pencils, blank cards, and scrap paper for invented roles, invented objects, and story lines only.
- Remind writers that every character is made up, with no real names, real places, or private details.
- Frame the goal as one playful paper character plus one story line, not a finished assignment.

Privacy and safety notes

- Do not ask writers to describe actual pockets, clothing, rooms, routes, schools, homes, relatives, or private places.
- Use fictional role labels such as cloud gardener, moon baker, paper inventor, or tiny museum guide.
- If a real name appears, replace it with a made-up character name:
- If a private location appears, replace it with a pretend story place:
- Keep all sharing local to the paper session and limited to invented words, sketches, or story lines.

Paper character setup

- Place the blank character cards inside the pretend paper coat pocket and let the adult handle the pocket between turns.
- On the first card, write an invented character role with no real person attached: _____.
- On the second card, write one harmless pretend pocket object for that character: _____.
- On the third card, write one tiny make-believe wish or question for the character: _____.
- Clip the three cards together so the writer has a paper character bundle before drafting.

Family handoff

- Send only the completed paper cards and slips, with no request for personal details or real-life descriptions.
- Invite the adult reader to ask for one favorite invented word from the card: _____.
- Suggest a short family read-through of one story line, with the writer choosing what to read: _____.
- Keep the pretend paper coat pocket label with the cards so the theme stays fictional and paper-based.
- Use the reset card if a writer wants a fresh fictional role instead of revising a real-life detail.

Story character coaching

- Ask what the invented character wants on the story page, then write the want in one short phrase: _____.
- Ask what the paper pocket object helps the character try, then write the helpful detail: _____.
- Coach one visible trait that appears through action, such as careful, bold, or curious: _____.
- Guide the writer to add one line the character could say in a pretend scene: _____.
- If the idea turns toward real people or real places, redirect to a fictional role and setting: _____.

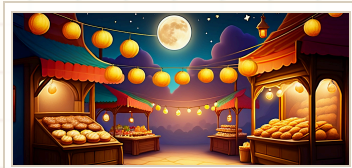
Reset

- Collect loose cards, remove any real names or private-place details, and keep only fictional paper pieces.
- Return unused blanks to the pretend paper coat pocket for the next adult-led round.
- Invite one fresh invented role to restart the set:
- Store the pack flat with pencils and blank slips for the next paper session.

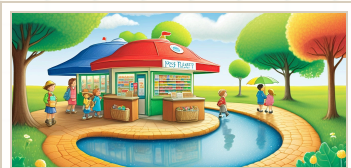
Use one paper character card at a time. Keep every choice broad, invented, and screen-free.

Sixteen character-card worlds

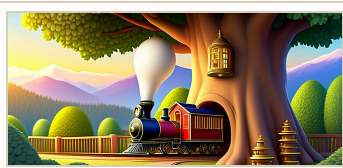
Pick a world image, then create one fictional character from a pretend paper pocket item.



AGES 6-8
Moon Muffin Market



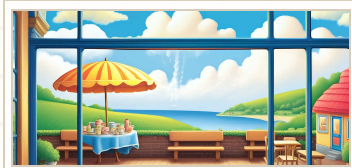
AGES 6-8
Puddle Planet Post Office



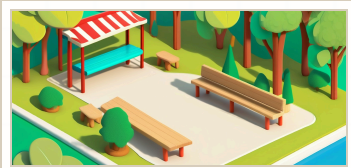
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AGES 7-9
Button Bakery Map Mix-Up



AGES 7-8
Teacup Town Weather Window



AGES 7-9
Pocket Park Notice Board



AGES 7-9
Spoon Ferry Lunchbox Harbor



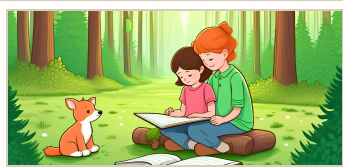
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Acorn Avenue Errand Office



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Choose the paper character rhythm

Paper Pocket Role Pull

- Starting a fictional character without using real identity details.
1. Adult places three blank cards inside the pretend paper coat pocket.
 2. Writer pulls one paper card and writes a made-up role: _____.
 3. Writer adds one harmless pretend pocket object for that role: _____.
 4. Writer starts a story sentence using the role and object: _____.

Pocket Object Motive Match

- Connecting character wants to a safe story action.
1. Adult lays out two character cards and two object cards from the paper pocket.
 2. Writer pairs one invented role with one pretend object: _____.
 3. Writer writes what the character hopes the object will help with: _____.
 4. Writer writes the first try the character makes on the page: _____.

Trait Turnaround

- Showing how a fictional character changes across a story.
1. Adult gives the writer a Start Trait card and an Ending Trait card.
 2. Writer writes the character's starting trait: _____.
 3. Writer writes one paper-pocket object that helps the character practice a new choice: _____.
 4. Writer writes the ending trait in a final story line: _____.

Button-Size Backstory

- Building a tiny character history that stays fictional.
1. Adult chooses a blank card and labels it Backstory Button.
 2. Writer writes one invented place from a fantasy setting, not a real place: _____.
 3. Writer writes one tiny reason the character carries the paper pocket object: _____.
 4. Writer turns the reason into one character line: _____.

Two-Card Character Voice

- Practicing dialogue without real conversations or recordings.
1. Adult picks one role card and one trait card from the pretend paper pocket.
 2. Writer writes an invented character name: _____.
 3. Writer writes one short line the character might say in a pretend scene: _____.
 4. Adult helps the writer add one action after the line: _____.

Character Card Chain

- Group or family table play with each person adding only fictional details.
1. Adult starts the chain with one invented role card: _____.
 2. Next writer adds one harmless pretend object card: _____.
 3. Next writer adds one made-up wish, question, or problem: _____.
 4. Final writer combines the cards into one story opening: _____.

Finish one story character later

SINGLE PAPER SLIP CHARACTER ROLE Moon Button Keeper Write an invented character who keeps a moon button in the pretend paper pocket: _____. Adult reader asks for one made-up word connected to the button: _____.	ONE SHORT CARD CHARACTER WANT Cloud Bakery Helper Write what a cloud bakery helper wants to fix, make, or find in a pretend scene: _____. Family reader can ask for one gentle action the helper tries: _____.
FOLDED SLIP CHARACTER VOICE Tiny Museum Guide Write one line a tiny museum guide says about an imaginary display: _____. Adult reader can point to a sketch and ask for one invented label: _____.	TWO-LINE CARD TRAIT THROUGH ACTION Paper Lantern Maker Write one careful action the paper lantern maker takes on the story page: _____. Family reader asks which trait the action shows: _____.
SMALL CARD CHARACTER DETAIL Pebble Orchestra Leader Write one pretend sound the pebble orchestra leader loves: _____. Adult reader asks for one invented instrument name: _____.	ONE PAPER POCKET CARD MOTIVE Pocket Signal Sorter Write why the pocket signal sorter carries a pretend signal token: _____. Family reader asks what the signal token helps with in the story: _____.
SKETCH PLUS LINE SENSORY DETAIL Ribbon Cloud Painter Sketch a pretend ribbon cloud and write one color or texture word: _____. Adult reader asks for one story sentence about the sketch: _____.	SINGLE SCENE SLIP SCENE ACTION Clockless Picnic Planner Write one pretend picnic item the character packs in the paper pocket: _____. Family reader asks what the item does in the story: _____.
ONE CHARACTER CARD CHARACTER CHANGE Acorn Page Turner Write how the acorn page turner feels at the start and end of the story: _____. Adult reader asks what choice helped the change happen: _____.	ONE CLOSING SLIP STORY ENDING Story Thread Finder Write one final line where the character uses the pretend pocket object kindly or cleverly: _____. Family reader asks for one favorite invented phrase from the ending: _____.

Optional share prompts

- Optional: read one invented character name from a paper card: _____.
- Optional: show one harmless sketch from a card and say one made-up word: _____.
- Optional: share one pretend pocket object and its story job: _____.
- Optional: read one character line from the paper slip: _____.
- Optional: point to a trait card and name the invented action that shows it: _____.
- Optional: share one fictional place name from the story page: _____.
- Optional: read the first sentence of a pretend character scene: _____.
- Optional: trade one blank card with an adult and add a new invented role: _____.

Moon Muffin Pocket Crumb Keeper

Adult setup: Adult: Place this card beside a drawn paper coat pocket and choose one market role together, keeping every detail fictional: _____.

With your adult, fill the blanks to make a market character who belongs on the paper card: _____.



Moon Muffin Market

Character name
Name prompt: Give the character a made-up market name or role label: _____.

Pocket item
Paper pocket item: Choose one pretend paper-pocket item the character carries, like a moon crumb tag or tiny tray ticket: _____.

Want clue
Want prompt: What gentle thing does the character want at the Moon Muffin Market?
_____.

Worry clue
Worry prompt: What small, story-sized worry makes the character pause? _____.

Action clue
Action prompt: Write one helpful action the character tries next: _____.

Voice choice
Voice prompt: Write one sentence that sounds like this character speaking on paper:
"_____."

Revise character
Revise character: Add one detail that makes the character less plain and more moon-market specific:
_____.

Quiet option: Adult points to the paper pocket item; writer copies one character word: _____. **Take-home line:** Make one new paper-pocket character from a pretend market clue: _____.

Puddle Planet Pocket Stamp Sorter

Adult setup: Adult: Draw one paper coat pocket on the card and offer two invented mail-room roles to choose from: _____.

With your adult, build a puddle-post character using only made-up paper clues: _____.



Puddle Planet Post Office

Character name
Name prompt: Give the character a splashy made-up name or helper title: _____.

Pocket item
Paper pocket item: Pick one pretend item tucked in the drawn paper pocket, such as a ripple stamp or floaty label: _____.

Want clue
Want prompt: What does the character want to sort, deliver, or fix in the pretend post office? _____.

Worry clue
Worry prompt: What gentle mix-up makes the character think twice before acting? _____.

Action clue
Action prompt: Write one careful next step the character takes with the mail clue: _____.

Voice choice
Voice prompt: Write one short line in the character's puddle-post voice: " _____."

Revise character
Revise character: Add one stamp, splash, counter, or label detail that shows who this character is: _____.

Quiet option: Adult names one paper item; writer adds one matching character word: _____.

Take-home line: Create another pretend paper-pocket helper for a make-believe mail counter: _____.

Buttonwood Ticket Pocket Page Turner

Adult setup: Adult: Place a pretend paper coat pocket beside a ticket shape and keep the character role invented: _____.

With your adult, give the library-train character a want, a worry, and one paper-pocket clue: _____.



Buttonwood Library Train

Character name Name prompt: Name the character with a fictional rail-library role, such as shelf rider or ticket page helper: _____.	Pocket item Paper pocket item: Choose one pretend paper-pocket item from the train library, like a lantern ticket or bookmark wheel: _____.
Want clue Want prompt: What does the character want before the next shelf stop? _____.	Worry clue Worry prompt: What small question or mix-up keeps the character from feeling ready? _____.
Action clue Action prompt: Write one action the character takes inside the pretend train car: _____.	Voice choice Voice prompt: Write one calm library-train sentence this character might say: " _____."
Revise character Revise character: Add one detail that connects the want to the paper-pocket item: _____.	

Quiet option: Circle want or worry first, then fill one short character blank: _____. **Take-home line:** Make one new library-train character with a ticket clue and a gentle want: _____.

Button Bakery Pocket Map Mender

Adult setup: Adult: Put the card next to a drawn paper coat pocket and a pretend bakery map, then choose one made-up role: _____.

With your adult, make a character who uses a paper-pocket clue to handle a map mix-up: _____.



Button Bakery Map Mix-Up

Character name Name prompt: Give the character a bakery-map name or role label that is completely invented: _____ _____	Pocket item Paper pocket item: Choose one pretend item in the drawn paper pocket, such as a crumb compass or button-map tab: _____ _____
Want clue Want prompt: What does the character want the map to help everyone find? _____ _____ _____	Worry clue Worry prompt: What small confusion makes the map hard to understand at first? _____ _____ _____
Action clue Action prompt: Write the helpful choice the character makes with the pocket clue: _____ _____ _____	Voice choice Voice prompt: Write one polite bakery-map line in this character's voice: " _____." _____ _____
Revise character Revise character: Add one bakery, button, crumb, or folded-map detail to sharpen the character: _____ _____ _____	

Quiet option: Adult points to the map clue; writer fills one choice word: _____. **Take-home line:** Invent another paper-pocket map mender with one clear helpful choice: _____.

Teacup Weather Pocket Ribbon Watcher

Adult setup: Adult: Draw a tiny paper coat pocket on the card and pick one gentle weather-window symbol together: _____.

With your adult, create a teacup-town character whose voice matches the paper weather clue: _____.



Teacup Town Weather Window

Character name
Name prompt: Name the character with a made-up teacup role or weather-window title:

Want clue
Want prompt: What does the character want to understand about the tiny weather window?

Action clue
Action prompt: Write one kind action the character takes near the teacup window:

Revise character
Revise character: Replace one plain word with a teacup or weather-window detail:

Pocket item
Paper pocket item: Choose one pretend pocket item, such as a cloud ribbon, saucer note, or spoon-sized forecast card: _____

Worry clue
Worry prompt: What gentle weather surprise makes the character speak carefully?

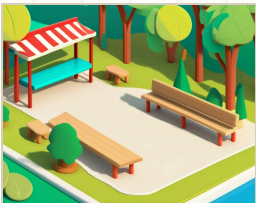
Voice choice
Voice prompt: Write one line that sounds careful, bright, or curious in this character's voice:
"_____"

Quiet option: Adult offers two voice words; writer chooses one and fills the blank: _____. **Take-home line:** Make another paper-pocket character who speaks like a tiny weather watcher: _____.

Pocket Park Tack-Tab Keeper

Adult setup: Adult: Keep the notice board fully make-believe, place a drawn paper coat pocket beside it, and choose one invented park role: _____.

With your adult, build a pocket-park character from one paper notice clue and one pretend pocket item: _____.



Pocket Park Notice Board

Character name Name prompt: Give the character a made-up pocket-park name or notice-board helper role: _____ _____	Pocket item Paper pocket item: Choose one pretend item in the drawn paper pocket, such as a ribbon tack, leaf label, or tiny note card: _____ _____
Want clue Want prompt: What does the character want the pretend notice to help with in the paper park? _____ _____	Worry clue Worry prompt: What small, gentle concern makes the character check the notice again? _____ _____
Action clue Action prompt: Write one action the character takes to make the paper notice clearer: _____ _____	Voice choice Voice prompt: Write one friendly pocket-park sentence this character could say: "_____" _____
Revise character Revise character: Add one notice-board, leaf, ribbon, or bench detail that makes the character memorable: _____ _____	

Quiet option: Adult reads the pretend notice clue; writer adds one role word: _____. **Take-home line:** Create one more fictional notice-board helper from a paper-pocket clue: _____.

Button Captain on Spoon-Ferry Pier

Adult setup: Adult: Fold the card so the pretend coat-pocket flap covers the prompts, then reveal one line at a time: _____.

Kid: Make up a character for the paper harbor world. Start with one safe pretend detail: _____.



Spoon Ferry Lunchbox Harbor

Character name
Give the spoon-ferry helper a made-up name: _____.

Pocket item
Name or draw the tiny paper item tucked in the pretend coat pocket: _____.

Want clue
Write what the character wants before the lunchbox tide turns: _____.

Worry clue
Write the small worry that makes the choice tricky: _____.

Action clue
Write one gentle action the character tries on the ferry pier: _____.

Voice choice
Write one sentence in the character's own voice: _____.

Revise character
Change one detail so the character feels more surprising: _____.

Quiet option: choose the pocket item silently, then fill this line: _____.

Take-home line: A character can start with one paper pocket item and one wish: _____.

The Acorn Stamp Clerk's Tiny Mix-Up

Adult setup: Adult: Place the card beside a pencil and call the coat pocket a pretend paper pocket, not real clothing: _____.

Kid: Invent an office character who helps in a made-up acorn avenue. First idea: _____.



Acorn Avenue Errand Office

Character name
Give the acorn stamp clerk a made-up name: _____.

Pocket item
Write the pretend paper pocket item that causes a tiny mix-up: _____.

Want clue
Write what the character wants to fix or finish today: _____.

Worry clue
Write what the character worries might be misunderstood: _____.

Action clue
Write one careful action the character takes at the errand counter: _____.

Voice choice
Write one polite line the character says: _____.

Revise character
Add one unexpected habit, sound, or motion to the character: _____.

Quiet option: point to a prompt, then fill just this blank: _____. **Take-home line:** A tiny mix-up can reveal what a character cares about: _____.

Map-Room Seed Keeper with a Folded Clue

Adult setup: Adult: Cut the card apart if desired and keep the pocket clue fictional, with no real addresses or private places: _____.

Kid: Create a map-room character from invented details only. First clue: _____.



Seed Library Map Room

Character name
Give the seed keeper a made-up name: _____.

Pocket item
Write the folded paper clue found in the pretend coat pocket: _____.

Want clue
Write what the character wants the map to help with: _____.

Worry clue
Write the character's quiet worry about choosing the wrong seed shelf: _____.

Action clue
Write one thoughtful action the character takes in the map room: _____.

Voice choice
Write one sentence that sounds like this character speaking: _____.

Revise character
Revise the character by changing the clue, the want, or the worry: _____.

Quiet option: fill one blank and let the adult read the card aloud: _____. **Take-home line:** A good fictional character has a clue, a want, and a worry: _____.

Rain-Gauge Conductor and the Puddle Ticket

Adult setup: Adult: Present the coat pocket as a drawn paper pocket on the card and keep the railway path imaginary: _____.

Kid: Make a conductor, passenger, or station helper for the pretend railway. Start here: _____.



Rain Gauge Railway

Character name
Give the railway character a made-up name: _____.

Pocket item
Write the pretend paper pocket item, such as a puddle ticket or gauge note: _____.

Want clue
Write what the character wants to understand about the rainy railway: _____.

Worry clue
Write what makes the character pause before acting: _____.

Action clue
Write one kind or clever action the character takes near the rain gauge: _____.

Voice choice
Write one line the character would say on the platform: _____.

Revise character
Change one trait so the character reacts differently to the rain: _____.

Quiet option: choose a role and fill this one blank: _____. **Take-home line:** A pocket item can show how a character solves a problem: _____.

Moss Message Signal-Sorter

Adult setup: Adult: Read the prompts aloud and remind writers that all names, places, and pocket items are made up: _____.

Kid: Invent a signal-sorter, moss reader, or signal helper. Begin with one imagined detail: _____.



Moss Message Observatory

Character name
Give the observatory character a made-up name: _____.

Want clue
Write what the character hopes to discover from the soft observatory signals: _____.

Action clue
Write one patient action the character takes while sorting messages: _____.

Revise character
Revise by adding one new quirk, tool, or rule for the character: _____.

Pocket item
Write the pretend paper pocket item that helps read moss messages: _____.

Worry clue
Write the gentle worry that keeps the character careful: _____.

Voice choice
Write one sentence in a calm character voice: _____.

Quiet option: draw the pocket item first, then name it here: _____. **Take-home line:** A character gets stronger when a job, item, and worry fit together: _____.

The Barnacle Button Keeper

Adult setup: Adult: Place this printable card beside the printed pretend coat pocket and remind the writer that every pocket item is made up on paper: _____.

Write a short scene where your tidepool lab character notices a tiny change and decides what to do next: _____.



Tidepool Timekeepers Lab

Character name
Give the fictional tidepool helper a made-up name: _____.

Pocket item
Choose one pretend paper-pocket item, like a shell button, kelp ribbon, or bubble note: _____.

Want clue
Write what this character wants to fix, learn, or protect in the tidepool lab: _____.

Worry clue
Write one gentle worry that makes the job harder: _____.

Action clue
Write one careful action the character takes with the pretend pocket item: _____.

Voice choice
Write one line the character says in a curious, careful voice: _____.

Revise character
Revise by adding one habit the character repeats when thinking: _____.

Quiet option: Write only the name, pocket item, and first action: _____. **Take-home slip:** Finish this sentence for another tidepool character: In my pretend paper pocket, I keep _____.

The Ferry Pilot With a Patchwork Oar Tag

Adult setup: Adult: Slide the card under the printed pretend coat pocket flap and frame the pocket item as a paper story prop only: _____.

Write a scene where the ferry character crosses Revision River and changes one idea before reaching the dock: _____.



Revision River Ferry

Character name
Name the fictional ferry character with a name that sounds ready for revision: _____.

Pocket item
Write the pretend paper-pocket item that helps them rethink a plan: _____.

Want clue
Write the first thing the character wants before the ferry ride begins: _____.

Worry clue
Write the worry that makes the character hold too tightly to the first plan: _____.

Action clue
Write the action that shows the character trying a revised choice: _____.

Voice choice
Write one line in the character's voice before or after the revision: _____.

Revise character
Revise by changing the character's want so it becomes more specific: _____.

Quiet option: Write the first plan and the revised plan in two short phrases: _____. **Take-home slip:** Invent another Revision River passenger and the paper-pocket clue they carry: _____.

The Label-Swap Curator

Adult setup: Adult: Hand over the card with the printed pretend coat pocket visible, and keep all clues imaginary museum labels on paper: _____.

Write a museum scene where the character notices one label that does not match its exhibit: _____.



Clue Label Tower Museum

Character name
Name the fictional clue-label tower character: _____.

Pocket item
Write the pretend paper-pocket item, such as a blank tag, tiny stamp, or folded exhibit note: _____.

Want clue
Write what the character wants the museum visitors in the story to understand: _____.

Worry clue
Write the character's worry about the mixed-up clue label: _____.

Action clue
Write one action the character takes to compare two imaginary labels: _____.

Voice choice
Write one thoughtful line the character says while studying the clue: _____.

Revise character
Revise by adding one surprising thing the character is good at noticing: _____.

Quiet option: Write only the mixed-up label and the character's first guess: _____. **Take-home slip:** Make a new fictional museum role and one pretend paper-pocket label: _____.

The North-Needle Apprentice

Adult setup: Adult: Put this card beside the printed pretend coat pocket and invite the writer to choose only imaginary craft materials: _____.

Write a scene where the apprentice tests a compass craft and learns something about how they make choices: _____.



Compass Craft Academy

Character name
Name the fictional compass-craft apprentice: _____.

Pocket item
Write the pretend paper-pocket item, like a paper needle, painted bead, or folded direction card: _____.

Want clue
Write what the character wants their compass craft to point toward: _____.

Worry clue
Write one worry that could make the character rush, guess, or doubt themselves: _____.

Action clue
Write the careful action the character takes before deciding which way to turn: _____.

Voice choice
Write one line that shows the character thinking through the choice: _____.

Revise character
Revise by adding one small flaw that makes the character more interesting but still kind: _____.

Quiet option: Write a three-part character note: tool, want, worry: _____. **Take-home slip:** Finish this new compass character idea: My pretend paper-pocket tool points toward _____.

The Button-Thread Boardwalk Binder

Adult setup: Adult: Set the card on the table with the printed pretend coat pocket showing; all boardwalk details should stay fictional and paper-based:

Write a scene where the boardwalk binder uses a pretend pocket item to help finish a loose story page: _____.



Binding Day Boardwalk

Character name
Name the fictional binding-day boardwalk character: _____.

Pocket item
Write the pretend paper-pocket item, such as a button card, thread tag, or folded page corner: _____.

Want clue
Write the promise the character wants to keep by the end of the scene: _____.

Worry clue
Write the worry that makes keeping the promise feel uncertain: _____.

Action clue
Write the action that shows the character choosing how to bind the ending together: _____.

Voice choice
Write one line the character says when they understand what the ending needs: _____.

Revise character
Revise by adding one earlier clue that makes the ending choice feel earned: _____.

Quiet option: Write the promise and the final choice only: _____. **Take-home slip:** Create another fictional binder and the pretend paper-pocket item that completes their story: _____.